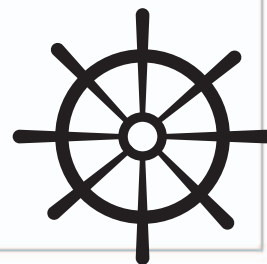




SHIP'S CAPTAIN

JOB DESCRIPTION

A ship's captain takes overall command of a vessel, its cargo or passengers, and crew. In this role, you oversee the navigation and handling of the ship, manage the crew, and ensure the safe and timely passage of cargo or passengers. Each class of vessel—from cruise ships and ferries to tankers and cargo ships—requires specialized skills, and every captain has a legal duty to keep an accurate log of voyages.



SALARY

Newly qualified officer ★★★★★

Experienced captain ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Wide range of opportunities across various sectors • Reduced demand for travel and goods during economic downturn can affect job prospects

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Seas and oceans • Ships and sailing • Geography • Mathematics • Engineering • Physics • Information Technology (IT)



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A good general education is required to train as a ship's officer. A degree in maritime science or similar is desirable.



LIFESTYLE Captains work in shifts and may also be on call. Leave periods vary in length, but are often one-for-one—the same length as your previous voyage.



LOCATION The captain is stationed on the ship's bridge, but also has an office onboard for paperwork. Captains spend long periods of time away from home.



THE REALITIES Responsibility for crew and passenger safety, and valuable cargo, makes this a high-pressure job. Overtime and reimbursed living costs boost pay.

CAREER PATHS

To become the captain of a ship, it is necessary to become licensed, either through an accredited training program or by passing a series of exams after spending many hours at sea. As you gain experience as a deck (navigation) or technical officer, you move through the ranks, taking more responsibility for other officers and crew.

TRAINEE With good school grades in English, science, and mathematics, you can apply to train as an officer. Training allows you to study while gaining onboard experience in junior positions.



GRADUATE You can apply for accelerated officer-training posts, or a range of junior officer positions, with a specialized industry-accredited degree.

